

Real Estate: Finance majors

Advising one-pager · BBA in Finance, 2026-27 catalog · Gatton College, September 2026

Which sheet? Wealth management or financial planning: CFP. Investment research or portfolio management: CFA. Real estate lending, investment, or development: Real Estate. Students can combine them. All sheets: willgerken.com/pathways

What it is

Real estate finance professionals lend on, invest in, value, and develop property. This three-course sequence through Gatton's **Real Estate Center** prepares students for careers such as commercial lending and finance, real estate investment and REITs, development, and valuation. Two of the courses fill the Finance major's FIN 400-level requirement and the third fills a free elective, so the pathway **adds no hours** to the degree.

The courses

Course	How it counts	Offered	When
FIN 360 Principles of Real Estate	free elective	Fall, spring	Any time; no prerequisite
FIN 464 ✓ Real Estate Finance	FIN 400-level slot	Fall, spring	After FIN 410
FIN 490 (Real Estate Development) ✓	FIN 400-level slot	Spring only	After FIN 405 and FIN 410, with FIN 464 first or alongside

FIN 490 is the department's special-topics number, so students register for the section subtitled Real Estate Development.

The posted four-year plan, with the real estate courses on top

Year	Fall	Spring
Freshman	CIS 110, MA 109, UK Core ×3	CIS 111, MA 123, UK Core ×3
Sophomore	ECO 201, ACC 200, MKT 300, STA 296, <i>elective</i>	ECO 202, ACC 201, MGT 301, MA 162, AN 105, FIN 360
Junior	ACC 301, FIN 300, ECO 391, CIS 300, <i>elective</i>	FIN 405, FIN 410, <i>elective</i> ×3
Senior	FIN 400-level, FIN 464 ✓, MGT 340, choose-one, <i>elective</i>	FIN 490 (Real Estate Development) ✓, AN 300, <i>elective</i> ×3

Pathway course **Counts for pathway and major** ✓ Major requirement UK Core, *electives* *Italic = recommended* **One term only**

The pathway takes one elective and two of the three FIN 400-level slots, leaving a FIN 400-level slot and the choose-one open. FIN 360 can move to any junior-year elective if a student finds the field later.

Three things to know

1. **It costs nothing extra.** One elective and two courses the major already requires at the 400 level.
2. **FIN 360 can start early.** It has no prerequisite, so a sophomore can take it and find out whether the field fits.
3. **FIN 490 (Real Estate Development) runs only in spring.** Plan it for senior spring, after FIN 405 and FIN 410, with FIN 464 in the fall before.

Get involved through the Real Estate Center

- **Real Estate Club** (open to all) and **Rho Epsilon Iota** for students who want to go deeper.
- Alumni and industry access, mentorship, and site visits; commercial real estate workshops and applied projects.
- Internships, and case and pitch competitions.
- FIN 464 also maps to Alternative Investments in the CFA® curriculum, so it serves a student weighing real estate and investment management.

Terms. FIN 400-level slot: one of the three upper-level finance courses the major requires. Choose-one: the major's single choice among ACC 302, ACC 475, FIN 359, or another FIN 400-level course. Free elective: any course the student chooses that counts toward graduation hours.

Faculty contact: Shaun Sanders (FIN 360, FIN 464, FIN 490 (Real Estate Development))

Plan from the 2026-27 Finance sample curriculum; prerequisites from the catalog. The catalog year a student entered under governs; confirm in the degree audit.